

ASE and Automotive Training Routes

NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

1. ASE: two different credential contexts

	ASE ENTRY-LEVEL	PROFESSIONAL ASE CERTIFICATION
Intended context	Students and entry-level knowledge checks	Working automotive professionals
Work experience	No work-experience requirement for Entry-Level credential	Relevant approved experience or qualifying training substitution required
Is passing one test the whole requirement?	Passing the Entry-Level test may earn that Entry-Level credential	No. A professional test score alone does not complete certification

Correct this claim: “I passed one automotive class test, so I am now a professional ASE-certified technician.”

One ASE detail I would verify on the current official page:

Source: ASE Entry-Level and ASE Work Experience Requirements. Accessed August 2026.

2. Route card A — Employer/on-the-job learning

Current BLS automotive guidance says many technicians complete a postsecondary automotive program, while some enter with a high school diploma and learn on the job.

What this proves:

What it does not prove about a specific employer:

Route card B — Registered Apprenticeship

Texas Workforce Commission describes a registered apprenticeship as paid employment with structured on-the-job learning, related instruction, mentorship, progressive wages, and sponsor-controlled admission.

One advantage:

One tradeoff or access question:

Why every dealership job is not automatically a registered apprenticeship:

3. Route card C — TCC public technical-college example

Published 2026-27 in-county tuition and fee estimates:

PROGRAM	CREDITS	PUBLISHED TUITION AND FEES
General Service Technician award	12	\$888
Engine Analysis Technician certificate	21	\$1,554
Heavy Line Technician certificate	29	\$2,146
Automotive Service Technology AAS	60	\$4,440

Important limit: estimates assume in-state, in-county tuition and exclude books and other materials.

What this source proves:

What the source does not prove for Jordan:

Two questions Jordan should ask before using the cost:

1.
2.

Source: Tarrant County College Automotive Service Technology, updated March 9, 2026.

4. Compare the routes for fictional Jordan

Jordan wants automotive work, needs income soon, can travel only within DFW, and may want an associate degree later.

DECISION FACTOR	EMPLOYER/OJT	REGISTERED APPRENTICESHIP	TCC EXAMPLE
When paid work begins			
Structured instruction			
Credential/completion evidence			
Published cost and exclusions			
Admission/sponsor question			
Advantage			
Tradeoff			

The factor that matters most for Jordan:

5. Recommendation and source audit

First route Jordan should investigate:

Fact 1 and source label:

Fact 2 and source label:

One missing fact that could change the recommendation:

Authorized next source or person:

Why this is an investigation recommendation, not a guarantee:

Done when

- ☐ Entry-Level and professional ASE are distinguished
- ☐ All three routes compared
- ☐ Two source facts retained
- ☐ One missing fact and authorized next source
- ☐ Recommendation addresses Jordan's priorities